

DC Security INC - Security Guard Training Program

Module 1: Introduction to the Security Industry

Learning Objectives

- Understand the structure and function of Ontario's private security industry.
- Recognize the significance of licensing, professional standards, and ethical conduct.
- Define the general duties and responsibilities of a security guard.
- Identify the legislative framework that governs the profession.

Section 1: Overview of the Security Industry

The private security industry in Ontario provides essential services that support public safety and crime prevention. Security guards serve as the first line of defense in protecting property, personnel, and information. Their presence helps deter criminal activity, assist in emergencies, and ensure order in various environments like malls, office buildings, hospitals, and construction sites.

The industry is regulated to ensure that individuals employed as security professionals meet minimum training, ethical, and performance standards. The Ministry of the Solicitor General oversees the regulation and licensing of security professionals through the Private Security and Investigative Services Act, 2005 (PSISA).

Section 2: Role of a Security Guard

A security guard's primary role is to maintain a safe and secure environment for people and property. This includes monitoring premises, controlling access, responding to incidents, writing accurate reports, and providing customer service. Their function is preventative, focusing on observing, reporting, and responding.

Section 3: Licensing Requirements

To work as a security guard in Ontario, individuals must:

- Be at least 18 years old
- Be legally entitled to work in Canada
- Have a clean criminal record
- Complete approved training and pass the licensing exam

Guards must carry their licence while on duty and present it when requested.

Section 4: Industry Standards and Ethics

Security guards are expected to:

- Act with integrity
- Follow applicable laws
- Avoid misconduct and impersonation of police
- Treat people respectfully and equally
- Refrain from using excessive force or being under the influence while on duty

Key Legislation and Resources

- Private Security and Investigative Services Act, 2005 (PSISA)
- Ontario Security Guard Study Guide
- Ministry Licensing Portal

Module 2: The PSISA & Code of Conduct

Estimated Duration: 2.5 Hours (1.5 hrs theory + 1 hr pre-reading)

Learning Objectives

- Understand the purpose and scope of the PSISA.
- Explain the legal and professional responsibilities of security guards under the Act.
- Identify the key elements of the Code of Conduct.
- Recognize prohibited behaviors and consequences of violations.

Section 1: What is the PSISA?

The PSISA governs the private security industry in Ontario. It establishes licensing requirements, sets ethical standards, and regulates security personnel to ensure public safety and professional conduct. It applies to anyone engaged in guarding people or property, loss prevention, or private investigation.

Section 2: Licensing and Legal Requirements

To be eligible for a security guard licence:

- Must be 18+
- Must be legally able to work in Canada
- Must have a clean criminal record
- Must complete training and pass the provincial exam

Guards must carry and show their licence when asked.

Section 3: Code of Conduct

Security guards must:

- Act with honesty
- Comply with all laws
- Treat everyone equally
- Avoid profane or abusive language

- Avoid excessive force or being under the influence on duty

They must not use police-like language or symbols, or misrepresent their authority.

Section 4: Uniform Regulations

Uniforms must display 'SECURITY' clearly, include ID tags, and must not resemble police uniforms. This maintains clarity and public trust.

Section 5: Complaints and Penalties

Public complaints can lead to warnings, licence suspension, fines, or imprisonment. Violations of the PSISA carry serious consequences.

Key References

- Private Security and Investigative Services Act, 2005
- Code of Conduct Regulation (O. Reg. 363/07)

Module 3: Basic Security Procedures

Estimated Duration: 3 Hours (1 hr in-class + 2 hrs pre-reading)

Learning Objectives

- Identify the general duties of a security guard across various site environments.
- Understand and apply access control, patrolling, surveillance, and crowd management techniques.
- Recognize the importance of observation, deterrence, and accurate reporting in daily operations.

Section 1: Duties of a Security Guard

Security guards must be vigilant and responsive to changing environments. Their primary responsibilities include:

- Protecting people, property, and information.
- Preventing and detecting criminal activity, including theft or vandalism.
- Responding to incidents and emergencies.
- Observing, recording, and reporting accurately and objectively.

These duties vary based on site conditions and employer instructions. Security guards must be aware of legal obligations and company policies at all times.

Section 2: Access Control

Security guards often control who enters and exits a site. Access control involves:

- Maintaining visitor logs with names, entry/exit times, and purpose.
- Issuing visitor passes with authorization details.
- Verifying credentials and restricting access where necessary.

Guards must be professional and vigilant while managing access, ensuring no unauthorized individuals enter secured areas.

Section 3: Patrolling Techniques

Patrolling ensures site integrity and helps deter threats. Types include:

- Foot Patrols: Best for indoor areas or high-traffic sites.
 - Pros: High visibility, full sensory awareness.
 - Cons: Limited range, affected by weather, tiring.
- Vehicle Patrols: Used for large outdoor properties.
 - Pros: Covers larger areas quickly, weather protection.
 - Cons: Reduced visibility and sensory input.
- Fixed Surveillance: Uses technology like CCTV or mirrors.
 - Pros: Continuous monitoring of specific areas.
 - Cons: May miss blind spots, requires functioning equipment.

Patrols should be random in timing and route to avoid predictability. Guards should prepare with maps, checklists, and equipment checks.

Section 4: Crowd and Traffic Control

In busy areas or during events, guards may be tasked with crowd or traffic management. This includes:

- Assessing risk to people and property.
- Following client instructions and emergency protocols.
- Using non-confrontational communication to de-escalate situations.

Guards must remain calm, observant, and avoid leaving their post unless absolutely necessary.

Section 5: Dealing with Drugs and Substance Abuse

Guards may encounter individuals under the influence. Responsibilities include:

- Identifying signs of substance abuse (e.g., erratic behavior, slurred speech).
- Ensuring personal and public safety by staying calm and avoiding confrontation.
- Noting presence of drug paraphernalia and reporting incidents immediately.

Knowledge of how different drugs affect behavior can help guards respond effectively and safely.

Key Responsibilities Summary

- Monitor, observe, and log activities.
- Control access to restricted areas.
- Respond to alarms or incidents per protocol.

- Maintain safety and professionalism under all conditions.
- Follow site-specific instructions and employer policies.

Module 4: Report Writing

Estimated Duration: 2 Hours (1 hr in-class + 1 hr pre-reading)

Learning Objectives

- Understand the importance of clear, objective, and factual report writing.
- Describe how to effectively use notebooks for daily documentation.
- Structure and write formal incident reports and witness statements.
- Recognize the legal relevance of written reports in court proceedings.

Section 1: Importance of Report Writing

Accurate report writing is one of the most critical responsibilities of a security guard.

Reports:

- Serve as official records of events, actions, and observations.
- Are used for internal reviews, incident investigations, and court evidence.
- Help maintain accountability, ensure legal compliance, and support proper communication with employers or law enforcement.

Poorly written reports can result in miscommunication, legal issues, or the failure to document key details of an incident.

Section 2: Notebooks and Note-Taking

A guard's notebook is considered a legal document. It must:

- Be chronological and well-organized.
- Never have pages removed or altered.
- Include accurate details such as:
 - Names of people involved
 - Time, date, and sequence of events
 - Observations, evidence, and actions taken

Best Practices:

- Use black ink and write legibly.
- Keep the notebook secure when not in use.
- Do not leave personal opinions or assumptions in your notes.

Section 3: Writing Incident Reports

Incident reports summarize events that occur during a shift. A good report must be:

- Clear – easy to understand, avoiding jargon or slang.
- Concise – only essential and relevant details included.
- Objective – free from opinions or guesses.
- Complete – answers the basic 5W1H:

- Who – names of all involved.
- What – what happened, what was seen or heard.
- When – time and date of events.
- Where – location of the incident.
- Why – known motive, if applicable.
- How – description of how the situation developed.

Section 4: Witness Statements

Security guards may be required to take witness statements. A proper statement includes:

- Full name, date of birth, and contact info of the witness.
- Time and place of interview.
- A verbatim account of what the witness recalls.
- An introductory paragraph and a closing paragraph (signed by the witness).

The witness must be given the opportunity to:

- Review the statement.
- Request corrections.
- Sign or initial any edits.

This process ensures the legal authenticity of the statement.

Section 5: Reports in Court

Reports and notebooks are often used as evidence in legal proceedings. Guards may:

- Be asked to testify in court.
- Refer to their notebooks on the stand to aid memory.
- Be cross-examined on report accuracy and consistency.

Professional tip: Always review your notes before attending court and ensure all entries are truthful and based on direct observation.

Module 5: Health and Safety

Estimated Duration: 2 Hours (1 hr in-class + 1 hr pre-reading)

Learning Objectives

- Understand the responsibilities of employers and workers under health and safety laws.
- Recognize workplace hazards and safety symbols.
- Know how to respond appropriately to hazardous situations.
- Identify the role of WHMIS and personal protective equipment in the security profession.

Section 1: Health and Safety Legislation

Security guards must comply with provincial laws to protect themselves and others in the workplace. These include:

- Occupational Health and Safety Act (OHSA)

- Workplace Hazardous Materials Information System (WHMIS)

Employers must:

- Provide training, protective equipment, and clear safety protocols.
- Post Material Safety Data Sheets (MSDS) for hazardous substances.
- Maintain emergency response procedures.

Section 2: WHMIS Overview

WHMIS ensures workers know how to:

- Identify hazardous products in the workplace.
- Interpret hazard symbols and labels.
- Understand MSDS documents and follow safety instructions.

WHMIS Responsibilities:

- Suppliers: Label and classify hazardous products.
- Employers: Provide access to MSDS sheets and training.
- Workers: Follow safety protocols and use PPE.

Common WHMIS Symbols:

- Flame = Flammable
- Skull = Toxic
- Exploding bomb = Explosive
- Gas cylinder = Compressed gas

Section 3: Identifying Hazards

Security guards may encounter several types of hazards:

- Biological (e.g., viruses, mold)
- Chemical (e.g., cleaning fluids, gasoline)
- Physical (e.g., noise, radiation, unsafe ladders)
- Ergonomic (e.g., repetitive tasks, improper posture)

Guards must report hazards, use proper equipment, and avoid unsafe practices such as blocking emergency exits or ignoring spill procedures.

Section 4: Emergency Situations

In the event of a health or safety emergency:

- Initiate the response plan and follow posted procedures.
- Evacuate the area if needed and restrict access.
- Contact the site supervisor, WHMIS team, or emergency services immediately.

Examples of emergencies:

- Chemical leaks or spills
- Explosions or fires
- Accidental exposure to dangerous substances

Section 5: Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)

PPE is essential for minimizing exposure to hazards. Security guards should:

- Wear gloves, masks, reflective vests, or goggles when required.
- Ensure equipment is in good condition and used properly.
- Know when and how to use PPE specific to their site.

Failure to use PPE could result in injury and violation of health and safety policies.

Module 6: Emergency Response Preparation

Estimated Duration: 4 Hours (2 hrs in-class + 2 hrs pre-reading)

Learning Objectives

- Understand the role of a security guard during emergencies.
- Recognize different types of emergencies that may occur at a site.
- Learn how to activate and follow emergency response plans.
- Apply effective communication and coordination during incidents.

Section 1: Role of the Security Guard in Emergencies

Security guards are often the first to respond to emergencies. Their duties include:

- Assessing the situation.
- Alerting appropriate emergency services.
- Initiating site-specific emergency procedures.
- Protecting people and property.
- Providing accurate reports and updates to supervisors and responders.

A calm and confident response is essential to maintaining order and safety.

Section 2: Types of Emergencies

Common emergencies that guards may encounter include:

- Fire
- Flooding or water leaks
- Medical emergencies (e.g., heart attacks, injuries)
- Bomb threats or suspicious packages
- Power outages or equipment failure
- Violence or active threats

Each type requires a different response and specific procedures.

Section 3: Emergency Response Plans (ERPs)

Every site must have an Emergency Response Plan. Guards must:

- Be familiar with the site's ERP.
- Know evacuation routes, emergency contacts, and first aid locations.

- Understand their role in fire drills and real emergencies.
- Ensure emergency exits and equipment are accessible and functional.

Section 4: Communication During Emergencies

Clear communication is vital in emergencies. Guards must:

- Use radios, phones, or intercoms to report incidents quickly.
- Speak clearly and calmly to clients, employees, or visitors.
- Provide accurate information to emergency responders.
- Avoid speculation or unverified claims.

Section 5: Coordination with Emergency Services

Security guards must:

- Greet and direct emergency responders upon arrival.
- Provide relevant information such as location, number of injured, or cause.
- Assist in crowd control and ensure clear access routes.
- Stay available for follow-up or witness statements.

Module 7: Canadian Legal System

Estimated Duration: 3 Hours (1.5 hrs in-class + 1.5 hrs pre-reading)

Learning Objectives

- Understand the structure of Canada's legal system.
- Identify the different levels of law: federal, provincial, and municipal.
- Recognize the difference between criminal and civil law.
- Understand the roles of courts, judges, and law enforcement.
- Understand how legal principles apply to security guard duties.

Overview of the Canadian Legal System

Canada's legal system is based on British common law and divided into three levels:

- Federal Law (e.g., Criminal Code, Immigration laws)
- Provincial Law (e.g., PSISA, Highway Traffic Act)
- Municipal Bylaws (e.g., noise regulations, curfews, parking rules)

Criminal vs. Civil Law

Criminal Law focuses on offenses against society and may result in fines or imprisonment.

Civil Law involves disputes between individuals or organizations and results in compensation, not jail time.

Structure of the Court System

- Supreme Court of Canada (final appeal court)
- Provincial Superior Courts (major criminal and civil cases)
- Provincial Courts (minor offenses and small claims)
- Administrative Tribunals (labour and landlord-tenant disputes)

Role of Law Enforcement and Security

Security guards have limited authority compared to police.

- May perform citizen's arrests under Section 494 of the Criminal Code.
- Must report crimes and cooperate with law enforcement.
- Must respect legal boundaries.

Legal Responsibility and Ethics

- Follow employer guidelines and the law.
- Maintain accurate documentation.
- Avoid misuse of authority or excessive force.

Module 8: Legal Authorities

Estimated Duration: 7.5 Hours (4 hrs in-class + 3.5 hrs pre-reading)

Citizen's Arrest – Section 494

- Permitted when an offense occurs on protected property.
- Must inform the person they are detained.
- Must hand over to police promptly.
- No excessive force allowed.

Use of Force – Section 25

- Force must be reasonable and necessary.
- Must be proportional to the threat.
- Deadly force only if there is an immediate threat to life.
- Proper documentation is required.

Search and Seizure

- Searches require consent unless for safety reasons.
- Bag checks must follow posted policies.
- Seized items must be logged and reported.

Trespassing Laws

- Guards may ask individuals to leave private property.
- Refusal may justify citizen's arrest.
- 'No Trespassing' signs are legally binding.

Powers and Limitations

- Cannot carry weapons unless licensed.
- Cannot arrest based on suspicion alone.
- Must follow employer protocols and cooperate with police.

Module 9: Effective Communication

Estimated Duration: 4 Hours (2 hrs in-class + 2 hrs pre-reading)

Role of Communication in Security

- Prevent and resolve conflicts.
- Provide clear instructions and warnings.
- Build trust with public and coworkers.
- Accurately report incidents.

Verbal and Non-Verbal Communication

Verbal: Speak clearly, use respectful tone, practice active listening.

Non-Verbal: Maintain proper posture, eye contact, facial expressions, and distance.

Barriers to Communication

- Language differences.
- Emotional stress.
- Noise or distractions.
- Assumptions or biases.

Use simple language, stay patient, and ask clarifying questions.

Radio Communication

- Identify yourself before speaking.
- Use short, clear sentences.
- Use phonetic alphabet when spelling names.
- Maintain professionalism at all times.

De-escalation Techniques

- Stay calm and composed.
- Avoid aggressive body language.
- Use empathy and active listening.
- Aim to reduce tension and avoid confrontation.